Our nine weeks of learning

October 13-December 18, 2026 | Family overview

We will learn through real books, objects, models and short investigations. Students can show learning by speaking, pointing, arranging pictures, using AAC or writing. We keep a predictable daily routine.

Week 1 | October 13 to 16

Helpers solve a problem by sharing what they have. | Books: Room on the Broom | Story focus: Notice the problem, the helper's action, and what changes next.

Book-centered connections: Math - Count and share "broom supplies" into equal groups; name the total or amount in each group. Science - Use broom, wagon and character props to test a push or pull and describe the change in motion. Social studies - Name how each helper contributes and connect the story to responsible classroom citizenship. Enrichment - Make a helper collage or build a paper broom with labeled passengers.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Make equal groups and find the total; then Share equally and find how many are in each group. (TEKS 3.4D, 3.4E, 3.4H, 3.4J). Grade 4 - Model division and connect the model to an equation. (TEKS 4.4E, 4.4F).

Science: Grade 3 - Show how a push or pull changes motion. (TEKS 3.7A, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Compare mixtures and show that the materials are still present. (TEKS 4.6B, 4.6C).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Recognize responsible citizenship and explain how people help their community. (TEKS 3.9C, 3.9A). Grade 4 - Identify why people explored Texas and connect an explorer to a route, goal, or result. (TEKS 4.2B, 4.2A).

Week 2 | October 19 to 23

A difficult problem changes when everyone works together. | Books: Big Pumpkin | Story focus: Sequence the stuck-pumpkin problem, the group's attempts, and the shared solution.

Book-centered connections: Math - Share pumpkin counters or seeds into equal groups and represent the groups with the week's operation. Science - Use a toy pumpkin or car to show how a push or pull changes position and motion. Social studies - Match each character to a team role and explain how cooperation helps the group. Enrichment - Create a lift-the-pumpkin paper chain showing each helper in order.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Share equally and find how many are in each group. (TEKS 3.4H, 3.4J). Grade 4 - Represent a two-step problem with operations, a diagram and a letter for the unknown. (TEKS 4.5A).

Science: Grade 3 - Show how a push or pull changes motion. (TEKS 3.7A, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Observe energy moving from one object to another. (TEKS 4.8A).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Recognize responsible citizenship and explain how people help their community. (TEKS 3.9A, 3.9C). Grade 4 - Connect motivations for exploration to specific explorers and outcomes. (TEKS 4.2A, 4.2B).

Week 3 | October 26 to 30

Everyone contributes a job so a shared plan can work. | Books: Pumpkin Soup | Story focus: Identify the characters' jobs, the conflict about changing roles, and the repaired plan.

Book-centered connections: Math - Use pretend soup ingredients to make equal groups or a simple input-output table for servings. Science - Connect stirring, scooping and warming to the week's energy target and record what the action changes. Social studies - Practice taking turns, sharing jobs and repairing a disagreement in a classroom community. Enrichment - Make a paper soup bowl with picture ingredients and a three-part problem/solution strip.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Share equally and find how many are in each group; then Show how two quantities change together in a table. (TEKS 3.4H, 3.4J, 3.5E). Grade 4 - Represent a two-step problem with operations, a diagram and a letter for the unknown; then Measure the space inside a rectangle and the distance around it. (TEKS 4.5A, 4.5C, 4.5D).

Science: Grade 3 - Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8A). Grade 4 - Observe energy transfer, test materials and build a closed circuit. (TEKS 4.8A, 4.8B, 4.8C).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Recognize responsible citizenship and explain how people help their community. (TEKS 3.9A, 3.9C). Grade 4 - Summarize why exploration occurred and connect explorers to outcomes. (TEKS 4.2A, 4.2B).

Week 4 | November 2 to 6

Autumn leaves travel wherever the wind carries them. | Books: Leaf Man | Story focus: Follow Leaf Man's movement across settings; use the leaf collages and page sequence as evidence.

Book-centered connections: Math - Sort leaf picture cards by color, shape or setting; count each group and show the week's table or fraction target. Science - Observe leaves in light and shade, then make a safe wind test and describe what changes the leaves' motion. Social studies - Compare familiar local places with the marsh, orchard and fields in the illustrations; identify how people use each place. Enrichment - Create a leaf collage character and map the places it visits in order.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Show how two quantities change together in a table; then Name equal parts of a whole and show a fraction. (TEKS 3.5E, 3.3A, 3.3C). Grade 4 - Measure the space inside a rectangle and the distance around it. (TEKS 4.5C, 4.5D).

Science: Grade 3 - Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8A). Grade 4 - Observe how sound transfers energy. (TEKS 4.8A).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Tell the difference between kinds of sources and use a source to learn about the past. (TEKS 3.14B, 3.14F). Grade 4 - Identify a major Texas Revolution event and place it in a simple cause/event/result sequence. (TEKS 4.3B, 4.3A).

Week 5 | November 9 to 13

Friends explore autumn places and collect leaves together. | Books: We're Going on a Leaf Hunt | Story focus: Sequence the friends' route, notice the leaves they find, and retell how the hunt ends.

Book-centered connections: Math - Sort and count the leaves collected on the story route; use the groups to model this week's fraction target. Science - Compare leaf colors, shapes and textures; record observations without claiming every local tree changes the same way. Social studies - Use a simple route map to connect the friends' journey with safe ways people explore and care for local places. Enrichment - Make a large-print route accordion with one leaf picture and location on each panel.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Find the central idea and supporting details. (TEKS 3.9D(i)). Grade 4 - Explain the central idea with evidence from the information book. (TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Name equal parts of a whole and show a fraction; then Build and take apart fractions using unit fractions. (TEKS 3.3A, 3.3C, 3.3D). Grade 4 - Use a rule to complete an input-output table. (TEKS 4.5B).

Science: Grade 3 - Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8A). Grade 4 - Observe energy transfer, test materials and build a closed circuit; then Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism. (TEKS 4.8A, 4.8B, 4.8C, 4.7).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Compare information from two simple sources about the same topic. (TEKS 3.14A, 3.14B, 3.14F). Grade 4 - Identify major events/people of the Texas Revolution and connect actions to outcomes. (TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B).

Week 6 | November 16 to 20

Fletcher worries when his favorite tree changes in autumn. | Books: Fletcher and the Falling Leaves | Story focus: Track what Fletcher notices, how he responds, and what he discovers after the final leaf falls.

Book-centered connections: Math - Build and compare equal leaf groups, then use visual fraction strips to show the week's unit-fraction target. Science - Observe leaf color and texture changes; test how air moves paper leaves and record what the test shows. Social studies - Discuss how Fletcher cares for a living thing and identify a helpful way to care for trees in the community. Enrichment - Make a tree collage with removable leaves and a three-part change-over-time sequence.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Build and take apart fractions using unit fractions. (TEKS 3.3C, 3.3D). Grade 4 - Use equal-size wholes to compare fractions and explain why. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D).

Science: Grade 3 - Identify everyday forms of energy; then Test how speed relates to mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8A, 3.8B). Grade 4 - Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism. (TEKS 4.7).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Use historical sources to support one claim about the past. (TEKS 3.14A, 3.14B, 3.14F). Grade 4 - Place major events/people in order and explain one cause/effect relationship. (TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B).

Week 7 | November 30 to December 4

One tree changes through the seasons, and each season brings different observations. | Books: The Seasons of Arnold's Apple Tree | Story focus: Compare what Arnold's tree looks like and what happens to it in spring, summer, fall and winter.

Book-centered connections: Math - Put four seasonal tree pictures in order and use the sequence to represent equivalent fractions or equal parts. Science - Use the book's seasonal details to observe how daylight, temperature and tree appearance can change across a year. Social studies - Compare how people use or care for a tree in different seasons; connect the examples to local community spaces. Enrichment - Make a four-season tree wheel with large picture labels and a clear seasonal sequence.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.9D(i), 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Show that different fractions can name the same amount. (TEKS 3.3F, 3.3G). Grade 4 - Use equal-size wholes to compare fractions and explain why. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D).

Science: Grade 3 - Test how speed relates to mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8B). Grade 4 - Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism. (TEKS 4.7).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Explain how people's actions can improve a community and identify a community need/solution. (TEKS 3.1A, 3.9C, 3.2B). Grade 4 - Identify key leaders/events of the Republic of Texas and explain movement toward statehood/annexation. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D, 4.3E).

Week 8 | December 7 to 11

A family prepares for winter, and each penguin responds in a different way. | Books: Little Penguins | Story focus: Notice the signs of winter, the family's preparations and the penguin who chooses to stay home.

Book-centered connections: Math - Compare picture groups of winter clothes or penguins with the week's fraction comparison strips. Science - Explore how clothing materials help keep a pretend penguin warm; observe and compare the test safely. Social studies - Recognize that family members can make different choices and identify ways a community prepares for cooler weather. Enrichment - Design a winter-weather outfit for a paper penguin and label each clothing choice.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Show that different fractions can name the same amount; then Compare fractions with the same numerator or denominator. (TEKS 3.3F, 3.3G, 3.3H). Grade 4 - Join or remove fractional parts with the same denominator. (TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B, 4.3E).

Science: Grade 3 - Test how speed relates to mechanical energy; then Demonstrate an energy idea and explain the observed evidence. (TEKS 3.8B, 3.8A). Grade 4 - Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism. (TEKS 4.7).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Identify a community problem and explain how people can work together to improve it. (TEKS 3.1A, 3.9C, 3.2B). Grade 4 - Explain one challenge/success of the Republic of Texas and connect events to annexation/statehood. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D, 4.3E).

Week 9 | December 14 to 18

Peter explores how a snowy day changes the places he knows. | Books: The Snowy Day | Story focus: Sequence Peter's winter experiences and explain what he notices from morning to the next day.

Book-centered connections: Math - Measure and compare pretend snow with cups or counters; show the week's capacity target with a visual record. Science - Use paper snow and a safe ramp to observe motion; compare Peter's snowy setting with local winter weather. Social studies - Notice the neighborhood places Peter visits and compare how children use familiar community spaces. Enrichment - Make a layered neighborhood scene with a beginning-middle-end winter walk sequence.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Compare fractions with the same numerator or denominator; then Choose a tool and measure weight or how much a container holds. (TEKS 3.3H, 3.7D, 3.7E). Grade 4 - Join or remove fractional parts with the same denominator. (TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B, 4.3E).

Science: Grade 3 - Demonstrate an energy idea and explain the observed evidence. (TEKS 3.8A, 3.8B). Grade 4 - Use a tested model to explain a force or energy transfer. (TEKS 4.7, 4.8A).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Show how an individual/group can improve a community using a problem to action to result explanation. (TEKS 3.1A, 3.9C, 3.2B). Grade 4 - Summarize one Republic/statehood event or leader and place it in the larger sequence. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D, 4.3E).

Friday routine

Each Friday: short spelling, reading, math and science checks. Science experiments: October 23, November 6, November 20 and December 11. The experiment provides the science check evidence. November 23-27 is fall break in this plan.

Individual learning outline

Student: _____ Current learning step: _____ Successful response mode: _____ Helpful supports: _____ Next challenge: _____ Family note: _____. IEP goals will be added after Stacie provides them.